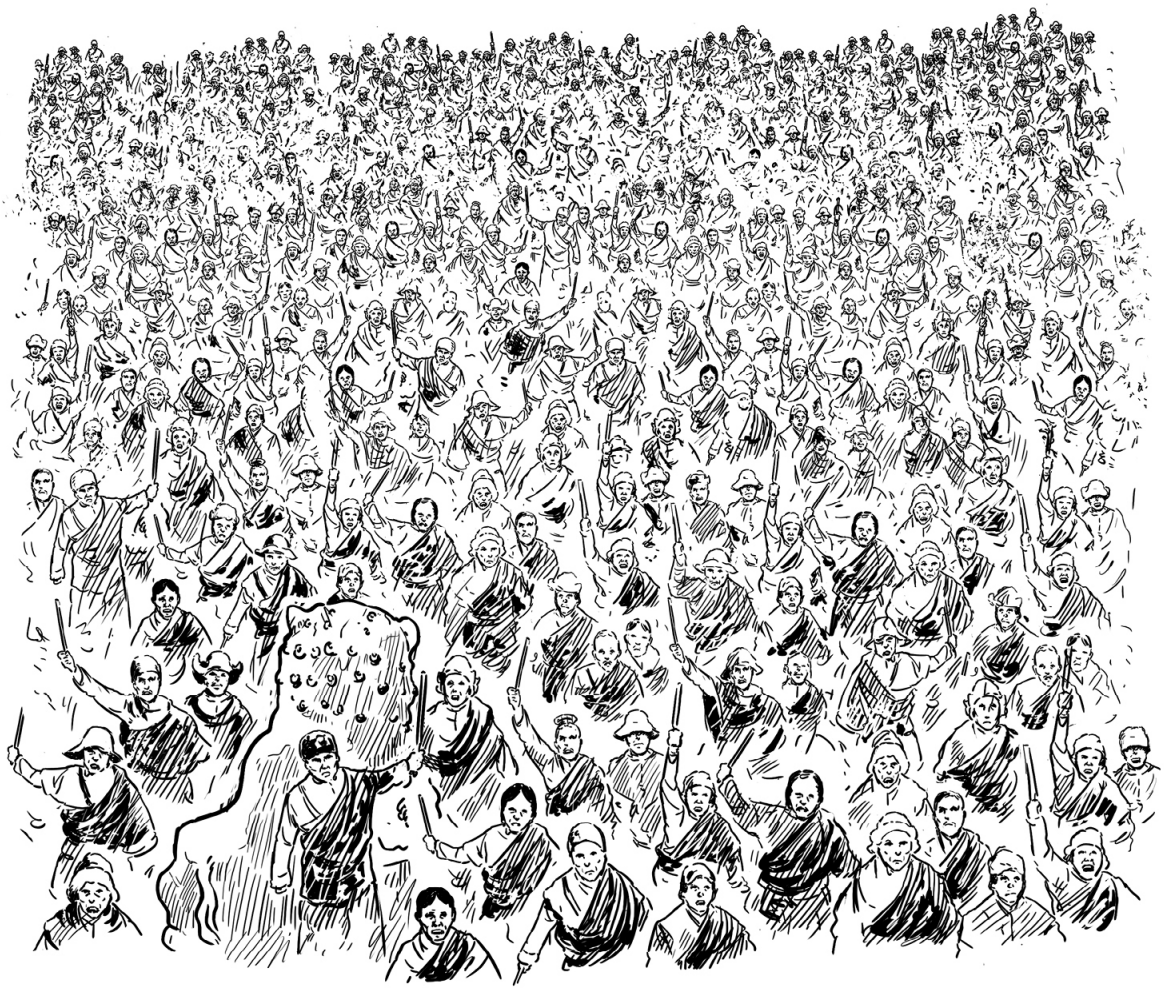


Early on the morning of March 10, he heard shouting outside his palace. The Tibetan people had surrounded the Norbulingka. They didn’t want him to go near the Chinese army’s headquarters. To protect him, they had brought along sticks, knives, and anything they could use against the Chinese.

The Dalai Lama prayed. He decided not to leave the palace. He didn’t want fighting in Lhasa’s streets. He worried about what might happen next.

The Tibetan crowd around the Norbulingka grew to about three hundred thousand people, including children and even monks who were willing to fight and die for the Dalai Lama. The Chinese aimed cannons at the palace. Both sides were getting ready for war.

The Dalai Lama’s advisors wanted to keep him safe. If he was killed, the Chinese would surely take over Tibet. So they told him he had to leave Lhasa. Protecting him meant protecting the future of Tibet.